

RH04

## Mewar: Guhil-Sisodia Dynasty

Rajasthan History gives 14-16 questions a paper, and Mewar is the most reliably tapped house inside it - expect 2-3, usually on Kumbha's works and titles, the three sakas of Chittor, or Haldighati.

Mewar is the richest single chapter in Rajasthan history and RPSC knows it.

The paper never asks you to discuss Mewar's greatness. It asks who built what, who fought whom, and in what order. Kumbha and Pratap alone can carry two questions in one paper.

### Mewar (Guhil-Sisodia)

#### Rawal line

- Guhil c.566 CE, Nagda
- Bappa Rawal = Kalbhaj
- Allat shifts to Ahar
- Jaitrasimha - Chittor capital
- 1303: first saka

#### Sanga to Udai Singh

- Khanwa 1527
- Second saka 1535
- Panna Dhaj
- Udaipur founded 1559
- Third saka 1568

#### The Sisodia turn

- Rana Hammir
- Singoli 1336
- Rana Lakha - Jawar mines
- Rana Mokal

#### Maharana Pratap

- Gogunda 1572
- Haldighati 1576
- Dewair 1582
- Chavand 1585

#### Maharana Kumbha

- Sarangpur 1437
- Vijay Stambh
- Kumbhalgarh (Mandan)
- Sangeet Raj, Rasik Priya

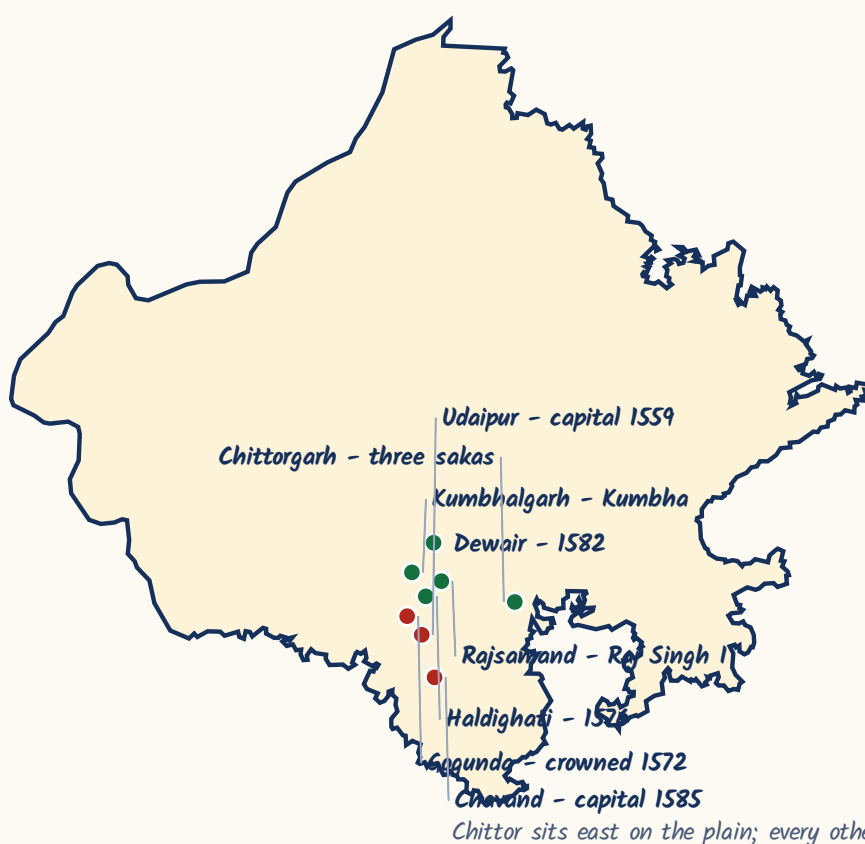
#### Udaipur Maharanas

- Treaty of 1615
- Rajsamand & Rajprashasti
- Jaisamand
- Fateh Singh, Bhupal Singh

**The frame - get this straight before any name**

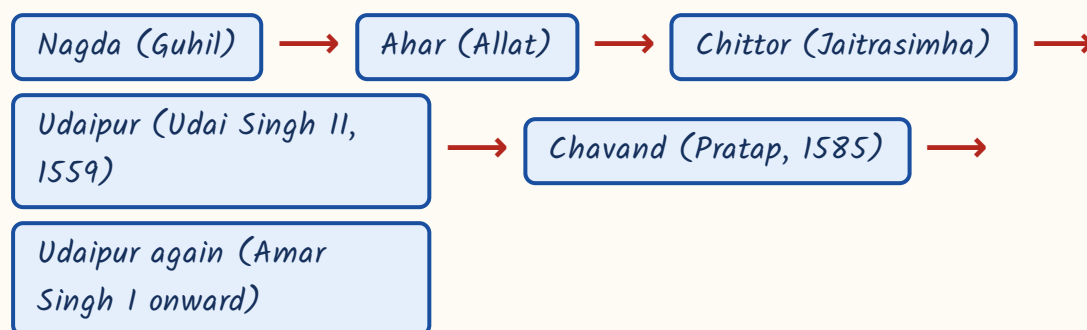
Mewar means southern Rajasthan - the country around Chittorgarh and Udaipur. The ruling house is the Guhil dynasty; from Rana Hammir onwards its ruling branch is called Sisodia. Early rulers are styled Rawal, later ones Rana and then Maharana. And one line RPSC likes: the ruler of Mewar did not claim to rule in his own name. He ruled as the Diwan (deputy) of Eklingji, the family deity. The god is the king; the Maharana is only his manager.

### Mewar on the ground - the places of this chapter

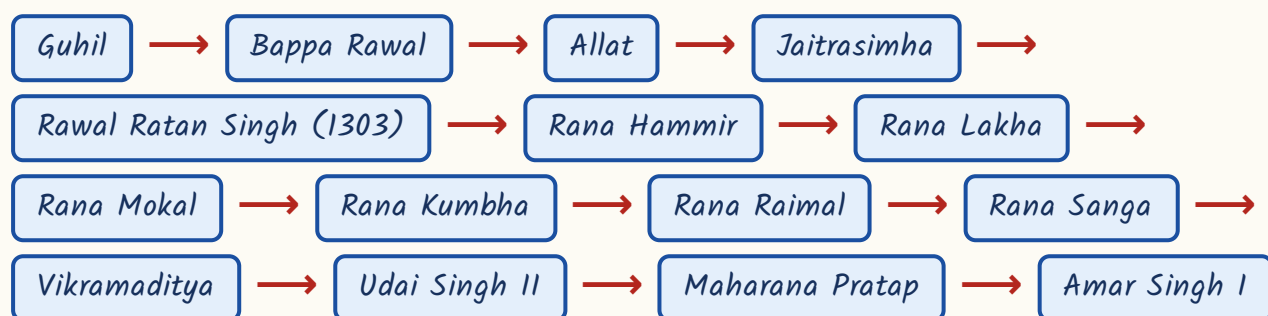


- Guhil (Guhaditya) founded the dynasty c. 566 CE; earliest capital Nagda (Nagahrada), near Udaipur.
- Eklingji at Kailashpuri is the tutelary deity - the Maharanas ruled as 'Diwan of Eklingji'.
- Allat shifted the capital from Nagda to Ahar - hence the 'Aharya' branch of the Guhils.
- Jaitrasimha (1213-1253) repulsed Iltutmish at Nagda and made Chittor the capital - the golden age of the Rawal line.
- Title ladder: Rawal, then Rana, then Maharana. Hammir is the hinge - first 'Rana', first Sisodia.
- Do not mix Nagda (Mewar's first capital) with Nagaur (Marwar, Akbar's 1570 darbar).

### Capitals of Mewar in order - a favourite ordering question



### The ruler chain you must be able to recite



### The Rawal line - Bappa Rawal to the first saka of Chittor

Bappa Rawal is where Mewar's own story really starts. The sources identify him with the name Kalbhoj, and that identification is itself an exam question. He is credited with taking Chittor from the Mori (Maurya) ruler Man Mori around 734 CE. Remember his two titles - they get matched.

- Bappa Rawal = Kalbhoj, c. 734 CE; wrested Chittor from the Mori ruler Man Mori.
- Titles of Bappa Rawal: 'Hindu Suraj' and 'Rajguru'.
- He did NOT shift the capital to Ahar - that was Allat. This exact pairing is planted as a false statement.

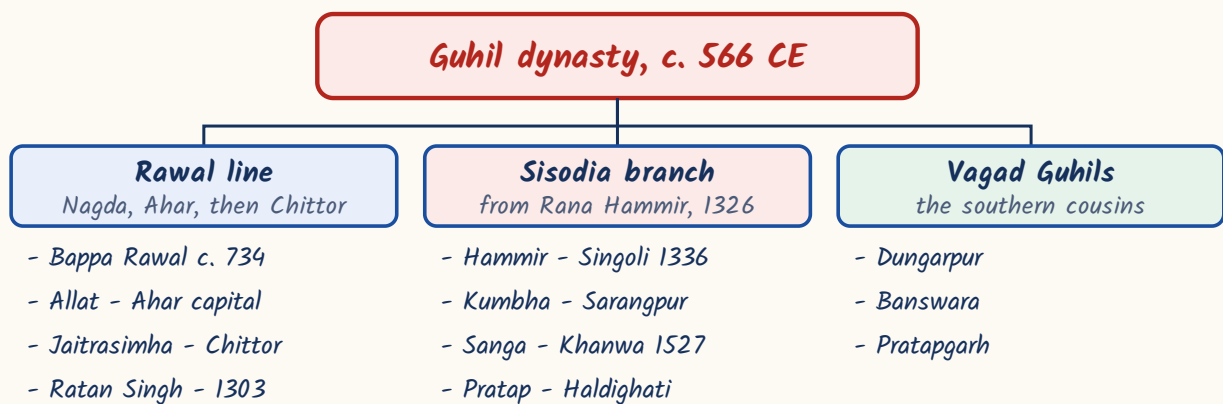
Now the first saka. A saka is the full ritual of last resort - the women perform jauhar, the men ride out in saffron to die. Chittor has three sakas and RPSC asks them as a set, so learn them as a set. And keep Rawal Ratan Singh of 1303 apart from Rana Ratan Singh II, Sanga's son - two different men, two different centuries.

- First saka, 1303 - Alauddin Khilji against Rawal Ratan Singh.
- The jauhar of 1303 is associated with Rani Padmini.
- After the capture Alauddin renamed Chittor 'Khizrabad', after his son Khizr Khan.

## **Rana Hammir - where Guhil becomes Sisodia**

After 1303 Chittor was out of Guhil hands. Hammir got it back. That single recovery is why the dynasty's later branch is named after him, and why his reign is the pivot of the whole chapter.

### The Guhil house and its branches



- Rana Hammir (1326-1364) recovered Chittor from Maldeo of Jalore.
- Defeated Muhammad bin Tughlaq at the Battle of SINGOLI, 1336.
- Founder of the SISODIA branch; first Mewar ruler to style himself 'Rana'.
- Title: 'Vishamghati Panchanan'.

- Rana Lakha (1382-1421) - the Jawar zinc-silver mines were discovered in his reign.
- Pichola lake was built in Lakha's reign, by a Banjara - not by a Maharana.
- Rana Mokal was Lakha's son by Hansabai of Marwar - that Marwar tie matters later.

#### TRAP

Lake-builder pairs are a standing negative question. Pichola belongs to Rana Lakha's reign, NOT to Raj Singh I. Raj Singh built Rajsamand; Jai Singh built Jaisamand.

**Maharana Kumbha - learn this section cold**

Kumbha (1433-1468) is the highest-yield single ruler in Rajasthan history. He is three things at once - a winning general, a compulsive fort-builder, and a working scholar of music. RPSC has asked his victory, his architect, his titles and his books in separate papers. Treat every proper noun in this section as an answer key.

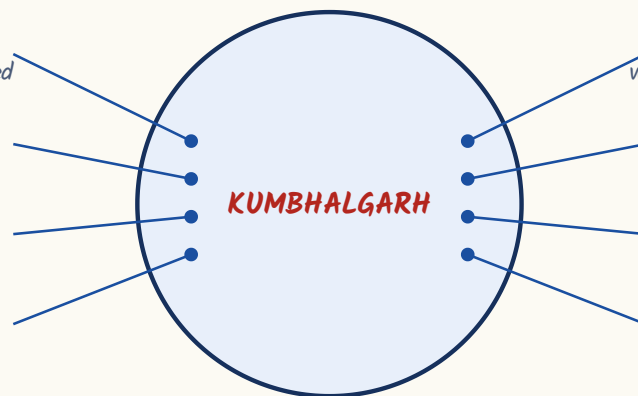
### **Kumbhalgarh - everything asked about one fort**

**Built by Rana Kumbha**  
one of the 32 forts he raised

**Wall about 36 km**  
second-longest in the world

**Pratap born here**  
9 May 1540

**Rajsamand district**  
Aravalli, north of Udaipur



**Architect Mandan**  
who also wrote Prasad Mandan

**Badal Mahal**  
the palace inside the fort

**Kumbha killed here**  
by his son Uda, 1468

**UNESCO Hill Fort**  
one of the six listed in 2013

- Defeated Mahmud Khilji of Malwa at SARANGPUR, 1437.
- Raised the VIJAY STAMBH at Chittorgarh to mark that victory - 9 storeys, about 37 m.
- Built 32 of Mewar's 84 forts.
- KUMBHALGARH - architect MANDAN; its wall runs about 36 km, the second-longest continuous wall in the world.
- Kumbhalgarh also holds the Badal Mahal and is the birthplace of Maharana Pratap.
- Murdered at Kumbhalgarh in 1468 by his own son Uda (Udai Singh I).

### **Kumbha's titles - straight matching material**

| Title                 | Sense                                            |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Abhinav Bharatacharya | The new Bharata - master of music and dramaturgy |
| Hindu Suratrana       | Hindu sultan                                     |

| Title     | Sense               |
|-----------|---------------------|
| Haalguru  | Lord of hill forts  |
| Rajguru   | Royal preceptor     |
| Danguru   | Master of giving    |
| Chhapguru | Master of the chhap |

### Kumbha's own works

| Work            | What it is                            |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------|
| Sangeet Raj     | His major treatise on music           |
| Sangeet Mimansa | Musicological work                    |
| Sudprabandh     | Musical / literary composition        |
| Kamraj Ratisar  | Work on kama-shastra                  |
| Rasik Priya     | Commentary on Jayadeva's Gita Govinda |

### Kumbha's court - scholar to work

| Scholar         | Works                                                         |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mandan          | Prasad Mandan, Roop Mandan, Rajvallabh, Devata Murti Prakaran |
| Natha           | Vastu Manjari                                                 |
| Govind          | Kalanidhi, Dwar Deepika                                       |
| Kanha Vyas      | Ekling Mahatmya                                               |
| Atri and Mahesh | Kumbhalgarh Prashasti                                         |

### Vijay Stambh vs Kirti Stambh - the trap RPSC sets every few years

| Vijay Stambh                                     | Kirti Stambh                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Built by Rana Kumbha, 15th century               | 12th century, well before Kumbha             |
| Hindu victory tower                              | JAIN tower, dedicated to Adinatha            |
| Commemorates Sarangpur (1437) over Mahmud Khilji | Built by the merchant Jijaji Rathore         |
| 9 storeys, about 37 m                            | The smaller of the two towers at Chittorgarh |

**ASKED IN RAS**

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 - the Vijay Stambh commemorates Kumbha's victory over whom? Answer: Mahmud Khilji of Malwa. The same paper asked Rasik Priya (commentary on Gita Govinda) and Sangeet Raj as Kumbha's works. In RAS Pre 2016 the architect of Kumbhalgarh (Mandan) and the title 'Abhinav Bharatacharya' were both asked. Four questions, one ruler.

**TRAP**

Prasad Mandan, Roop Mandan and Rajvallabh are works of MANDAN the architect, not of Kumbha. 'Which of these is NOT a work of Kumbha' is a real question format - the odd one out will be a Mandan title.

## Rana Sanga, and the three sakas of Chittor

Sanga (Sangram Singh I, 1509-1528) is the last Rajput ruler who genuinely tried to build an all-India confederacy. Before Babur he was winning. Learn his four wins, then his one defeat - the exam usually wants the sequence. Saka order by invader is easier still: Khilji, then Gujarat, then Mughal.

- Khatoli, 1517 - against Ibrahim Lodi.
- Bari (Dholpur), 1518 - again against the Lodis.
- Gagron, 1519 - against Mahmud Khilji II of Malwa.
- Bayana, February 1527 - against Babur's advance force.
- KHANWA, 17 March 1527 - defeated by Babur. Sanga died in 1528.

### The three sakas of Chittor - learn them as a block

| Saka  | Year and invader      | Mewar side        | Remembered for                                        |
|-------|-----------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| First | 1303, Alauddin Khilji | Rawal Ratan Singh | Jauhar linked to Rani Padmini; fort renamed Khizrabad |

| Saka   | Year and invader                 | Mewar side                  | Remembered for                                               |
|--------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Second | 1535, Bahadur Shah of Gujarat    | Vikramaditya was Rana       | Jauhar led by Rani Karnavati                                 |
| Third  | 23 Oct 1567 - 23 Feb 1568, Akbar | Udai Singh II had withdrawn | Jaimal of Merta and Patta (Fatta) of Kelwa fell defending it |

- After the second saka Banbir usurped the Mewar throne in 1536.
- Panna Dhai saved the infant Udai Singh II from Banbir by sacrificing her own son Chandan.
- Udai Singh II founded UDAIPUR in 1559 and made it the new capital.
- Akbar set up statues of Jaimal and Patta at the gate of Agra Fort - that detail is itself asked.

## Maharana Pratap

Pratap's dates and places are asked more often than the details of his battles. Fix the five places first - born, crowned, fought, won, died - and everything else hangs off them.

- Born 9 May 1540 at Kumbhalgarh.
- Coronation at GOGUNDA in 1572.
- Battle of Haldighati, 18 June 1576.
- Battle of Dewair, 1582.
- Chavand made capital in 1585; died there on 19 January 1597.

*Haldighati is misremembered by most students as Pratap versus Akbar. It was not. Akbar was not present. The Mughal army was commanded by a Rajput - Man Singh I of Amber - with Asaf Khan. And Pratap's own army had an Afghan contingent under Hakim Khan Sur. That crossing-over is exactly what the exam tests.*

### *Haldighati, 18 June 1576 - who was actually there*

#### **Man Singh I**

commanded FOR the Mughals

#### **Akbar**

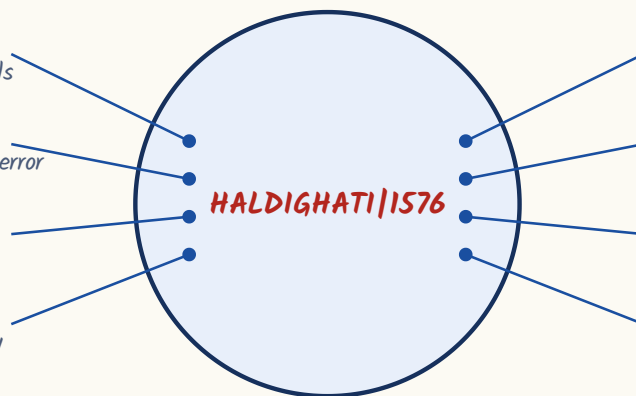
was NOT present - the top error

#### **Jhala Man (Bida)**

wore Pratap's insignia

#### **Outcome**

indecisive; Pratap gets away



#### **Asaf Khan**

with the Mughal force

#### **Hakim Khan Sur**

Afghans, on Pratap's side

#### **Chetak**

Pratap's horse

#### **Colonel Tod's name**

the Thermopylae of Mewar

- Mughal command: Man Singh I of Amber, with Asaf Khan.
  - Hakim Khan Sur led the Afghan contingent on Pratap's side.
  - Jhala Man (Bida) wore Pratap's insignia to draw the enemy and let him escape.
  - Pratap's horse: Chetak.
  - Colonel Tod called Haldighati the 'Thermopylae of Mewar'.
- 
- DEWAIR (1582) was the decisive win - Tod called it the 'Marathon of Mewar'.
  - Bhamashah financed the struggle out of his own wealth.
  - Punja Bhil led the Bhils who fought alongside Pratap.
  - After Dewair Pratap recovered most of Mewar - but not Chittor, Ajmer or Mandalgarh.

**ASKED IN RAS**

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - who commanded the Mughal army at Haldighati?

Answer: Man Singh I of Amber. Learn the commander, not the legend.

**YAAD RAKHO**

Pratap's five places in life-order: Kumbhalgarh (born) - Gogunda (crowned) - Haldighati (fought) - Dewair (won) - Chavand (capital and death). K-G-H-D-C.

**TRAP**

'Pratap recaptured Chittorgarh after Dewair' is a planted false statement. He never took Chittor back.

**CURRENT LINK**

Current link (as of August 2026): the Rajasthan government cleared a MAHARANA PRATAP TOURIST CIRCUIT of over Rs 206 crore covering Chavand, Haldighati, Gogunda, Kumbhalgarh, Dewair and Udaipur, alongside a tribal circuit (Beneshwar Dham, Mangarh Dham) in a package of over Rs 306 crore. Useful twice - a current-affairs fact, and Pratap's geography in one line.

**After Pratap - the 1615 settlement and the Sagar footnote**

---

Amar Singh I fought on for years and then made terms. Mewar was the last of the big Rajput states to settle with the Mughals, and it settled on unusually soft conditions. The four clauses of the 1615 treaty are asked directly and in the negative form - 'which was NOT a provision'. The commonest wrong option is a marriage clause, and Mewar never had one: it is the one major Rajput state that never gave a daughter to the Mughals.

- Treaty of 1615 - Amar Singh I with Jahangir, negotiated by Prince Khurram (the future Shah Jahan).
  - Clause 1: no matrimonial alliance with the Mughals.
  - Clause 2: the Rana need not attend court in person - Prince Karan Singh went instead.
  - Clause 3: Chittor returned, but never to be repaired or refortified.
  - Clause 4: Mewar to supply 1,500 horse to imperial service.
- 
- Sagar, a son of Udai Singh II, went over to the Mughals.
  - Akbar had already invested Sagar with the title of Rana; the Mughals then set him up at Chittor as a rival Rana - the so-called Chittor branch.
  - It was a Mughal counter-claim, not a real dynasty; the arrangement lapsed with the 1615 settlement.

### **The Udaipur Maharanas - builders, inscriptions and the last act**

From Karan Singh onwards Mewar stops being a war story and becomes a building-and-patronage story. That suits RPSC, which loves builder-to-building matching. Take this section as a matching table, not as narrative history.

- Karan Singh built Jagmandir on Lake Pichola and sheltered the rebel Prince Khurram there.
- Jagat Singh I built the Jagdish temple, Udaipur (1651); his reign is the golden age of Mewar painting under Sahibdin.
- Raj Singh I (1652-1680) built RAJSAMAND lake as a famine-relief work.
- The RAJPRASHASTI of Ranchhod Bhatt, on 25 slabs at Nauchowki, is the largest stone inscription in India.
- Raj Singh married Charumati of Kishangarh, installed Shrinathji at Sihad (Nathdwara) in 1672 and opposed Aurangzeb's jaziya.
- Maharana Jai Singh built JAISAMAND (Dhebar) lake.
- Amar Singh II concluded the DEBARI agreement (1708) with Ajit Singh of Marwar and Sawai Jai Singh II of Amber - a joint Rajput front.
- Sangram Singh II built Saheliyon ki Bari, Udaipur.
- Jagat Singh II presided over the HURDA conference, 17 July 1734.
- Bhim Singh signed Mewar's treaty with the British on 13 January 1818.
- Col. James Tod became the first Political Agent in Mewar; the Krishna Kumari episode belongs to Bhim Singh's reign.
- Maharana Fateh Singh refused to attend Lord Curzon's Delhi Durbar of 1903 - the one act of his reign that gets asked.
- Bhupal Singh, the last Maharana, became the first Rajpramukh of the United State of Rajasthan on 18 April 1948.

**Builder to building - revise this as a matching set**

| Structure / lake             | Builder or reign                        |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Vijay Stambh and Kumbhalgarh | Rana Kumbha                             |
| Kirti Stambh (Jain)          | Merchant Jijaji Rathore, 12th century   |
| Pichola lake                 | Reign of Rana Lakha, built by a Banjara |
| Udaipur city                 | Udai Singh II, 1559                     |
| Jagmandir                    | Karan Singh                             |

| Structure / lake                | Builder or reign    |
|---------------------------------|---------------------|
| Jagdish temple                  | Jagat Singh I, 1651 |
| Rajsamand lake and Rajprashasti | Raj Singh I         |
| Jaisamand (Dhebar) lake         | Maharana Jai Singh  |
| Saheliyon ki Bari               | Sangram Singh II    |

**ASKED IN RAS**

RAS Pre 2016 ran a match-the-following of work to author. Mewar supplies two of the standard pairs - Sangeet Raj to Kumbha, Rajprashasti to Ranchhod Bhatt. Keep those two apart from each other and you will not lose the mark.

**CURRENT LINK**

Current link (as of 2026): Nathdwara in Rajsamand, where Raj Singh I installed Shrinathji in 1672, now also carries the 'Statue of Belief' (Vishwas Swaroopam) - a 369-foot seated figure of Shiva unveiled in 2022 and billed as the tallest Shiva statue in the world. Note how much of this chapter sits in one district: Rajsamand holds Kumbhalgarh, Haldighati, Dewair, the Rajsamand lake with the Rajprashasti, and Nathdwara.

## Every Mewar battle on one page

Chronological ordering is a small but permanent slice of the paper - about 3% - and battles are the easiest place to lose that mark. Learn the table by its year column. The drill that works: Singoli 1336, Sarangpur 1437, Khanwa 1527, Haldighati 1576. That is exactly how the ordering question is built.

**Mewar's battles - year, sides, outcome**

| Battle and year          | Mewar side                 | Opponent                  | Outcome                                             |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Singoli, 1336            | Rana Hammir                | Muhammad bin Tughlaq      | Mewar wins; Chittor secured                         |
| Sarangpur, 1437          | Rana Kumbha                | Mahmud Khilji of Malwa    | Mewar wins; Vijay Stambh raised                     |
| Khatoli, 1517            | Rana Sanga                 | Ibrahim Lodi              | Mewar wins                                          |
| Bari (Dholpur), 1518     | Rana Sanga                 | Lodi forces               | Mewar wins                                          |
| Gagron, 1519             | Rana Sanga                 | Mahmud Khilji II of Malwa | Mewar wins                                          |
| Bayana, Feb 1527         | Rana Sanga                 | Babur's advance force     | Mewar wins                                          |
| KHANWA, 17 March 1527    | Sanga's Rajput confederacy | Babur                     | Mewar defeated; Mughal power settled                |
| Haldighati, 18 June 1576 | Maharana Pratap            | Mughals under Man Singh I | Indecisive; Pratap escapes - 'Thermopylae of Mewar' |
| Dewair, 1582             | Maharana Pratap            | Mughal garrisons          | Decisive Mewar win - 'Marathon of Mewar'            |

- Pairing errors RPSC plants: Kumbha with Khanwa (that is Sanga), Hammir with Sarangpur (that is Kumbha).
- Only two of these are outright Mewar defeats in the exam's eyes - Khanwa, and the sakas of Chittor.

### REVISION RECAP

1. Guhil c.566 CE at Nagda; Allat moved to Ahar; Jaitrasimha made Chittor the capital and stopped Itutmish.
2. Bappa Rawal = Kalbhoj; took Chittor from Man Mori; titles Hindu Suraj and Rajguru.
3. Maharanas ruled as Diwan of Eklingji - the deity is the nominal sovereign.
4. Sakas of Chittor: 1303 Alauddin (Ratan Singh, Padmini, Khizrabad), 1535 Bahadur Shah (Karnavati), 1567-68 Akbar (Jaimal and Patta).

5. Hammir: Singoli 1336 over Muhammad bin Tughlaq; founder of the Sisodia branch; first 'Rana'; Vishamghati Panchanan.
6. Rana Lakha - Jawar zinc-silver mines; Pichola built in his reign.
7. Kumbha: Sarangpur 1437, Vijay Stambh (9 storeys, c.37 m), 32 of 84 forts, Kumbhalgarh by Mandan with a 36-km wall.
8. Kumbha wrote Sangeet Raj, Sangeet Mimansa, Sudprabandh, Kamraj Ratisar, Rasik Priya; killed by his son Uda in 1468.
9. Kirti Stambh is Jain, Adinatha, 12th century, by Jijaji Rathore - keep it away from Kumbha.
10. Sanga won Khatoli 1517, Bari 1518, Gagron 1519, Bayana 1527; lost Khanwa to Babur on 17 March 1527.
11. Panna Dhai gave up her son Chandan to save Uda Singh II from Banbir; Udaipur founded 1559.
12. Pratap: born Kumbhalgarh 1540, crowned Gogunda 1572, Haldighati 1576, Dewair 1582, Chavand 1585, died 1597.
13. Haldighati - Mughal side under Man Singh I; Hakim Khan Sur and Jhala Man on Pratap's side; Chetak; 'Thermopylae of Mewar'.
14. Treaty of 1615 - Amar Singh I and Jahangir via Khurram: no marriage tie, no personal attendance, Chittor back but unrepaired, 1,500 horse.
15. Sagar was the Mughals' rival Rana at Chittor - a counter-claim that died with the 1615 treaty.
16. Raj Singh I: Rajsamand as famine relief, Rajprashasti by Ranchhod Bhatt on 25 slabs, Shrinathji at Nathdwara 1672, opposed jaziya.
17. Jaisamand by Maharana Jai Singh; Debari agreement 1708; Saheliyon ki Bari by Sangram Singh II; Hurda conference 1734.
18. Bhim Singh's British treaty 13 January 1818; Tod first Political Agent in Mewar.
19. Fateh Singh boycotted the 1903 Delhi Durbar; Bhupal Singh became the first Rajpramukh on 18 April 1948.